speak in a single, cohesive, and responsible voice, suggesting to other countries that U.S. foreign policy is in disarray and making it difficult for our diplomats to conduct a coherent policy. I'm not saying there aren't many patriotic and reasonable men and women in Congress, or that they shouldn't fight for principles they believe in. Congress is a partner with the president in foreign affairs as well as domestic matters; wisdom is not limited to the occupant of the White House. But there are some situations in which only the president can and does know all the facts; he should be permitted to *lead* the nation and make decisions based upon what he knows and the trust placed in him by the voters—although I never felt these views should justify overriding or ignoring validly enacted laws.

Too often, in my experience, Congress reminds us that it is a political organism. The central preoccupation of too many of its members is getting reelected; too often, instead of legislative statesmanship, this produces cynical posturing and pandering to the campaign contributors that have the fattest wallets.

In 1984, 1985, and 1986, as Tip O'Neill and his allies intensified their campaign to abandon the Contras, the Nicaraguan freedom fighters began to face shortages of guns and ammunition, sometimes even of food and medical supplies. It didn't help matters when Tip, declaring he was going to retire in 1986, asked fellow Democrats to vote against the Contras as a farewell gift. Now we had the emotional sentiment surrounding a very popular Speaker of the House involved in setting foreign policy.

While I battled with Congress to get support for the Contras reinstated, I felt we had to do everything we legally could to keep the force in existence. I told the staff: We can't break the law, but, within the law, we have to do whatever we can to help the Contras survive.